

SCIENCE OF READING REVIEW: OUACHITA BAPTIST UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: November 18-20, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

This report uses evidence from an on-site review to examine how an educator preparation program prepares candidates to teach reading using scientific reading instruction, as Arkansas requires of every approved program. It is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

The on-site reviews are carried out by Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US), an external review organization. TPI-US teams inspect coursework and course materials, observe instruction and clinical practice, review program data, and hold focus groups with candidates, faculty, mentor teachers, and school partners. Division of Elementary and Secondary Education staff participate in the review.

TPI-US rates the program in the three review areas of the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

- Review Area 1, "Quality of Literacy Coursework," is rated from course materials, syllabi, assignments, and observations of instruction.
- Review Area 2, "Quality of Field-Based Experiences," is rated from placement records, observation and feedback evidence, and focus groups with candidates, mentor teachers, faculty, and school partners.
- Review Area 3, "Quality of Performance Management and Continuous Improvement," is rated from program data systems, quality-control checkpoints, monitoring practice, and partnership evidence.

Every review area receives a rating. Depending on the framework version, the report may also rate each criterion; some earlier reports discuss every criterion without stating a separate rating for it. Performance Levels are defined as follows, in language drawn from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

PERFORMANCE LEVEL	WHAT THE RATING MEANS
4 — EXCEEDS	Coursework and training CONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
3 — MEETS	Coursework and training USUALLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
2 — APPROACHING	Coursework and training INCONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
1 — BELOW	Coursework and training RARELY OR DO NOT address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.

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REVIEW AREA PERFORMANCE LEVELS		
REVIEW AREA 1 LITERACY COURSEWORK	REVIEW AREA 2 FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES	REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT
MEETS	APPROACHING	APPROACHING
CRITERIA REVIEWED		
9	11	7
CORRECTIVE ACTION STATUS		
Corrective action determination issued for this review cycle. The Division identified 8 corrective actions for this program, of which 3 are required.		

PROGRAM INFORMATION

INSTITUTION NAME	Ouachita Baptist University
LOCATION	Arkadelphia, Arkansas
PROGRAM REVIEWED	Literacy coursework in the elementary, middle, and secondary education programs
PATHWAY	Traditional
REVIEW FRAMEWORK	TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024)
REVIEWING BODY	Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US)
SITE VISIT DATES	November 18-20, 2024

REVIEW AREA 1: QUALITY OF LITERACY COURSEWORK

REVIEW AREA 1 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
MEETS 9 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Overview of the science of reading	Meets
Concepts of print instruction	Meets
Collaborative communication, oral language instruction	Meets
Phonological and phonemic awareness instruction	Exceeds
Phonics, orthography, automatic word recognition instruction	Exceeds
Fluency instruction	Exceeds
Vocabulary instruction	Meets
Text comprehension instruction	Exceeds
Writing instruction	Meets
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found an evidence-based literacy curriculum aligned to the science of reading and delivered through four courses: Reading Children's Literature, Reading Foundations, Reading and Writing, and Reading Diagnostics. Instruction in phonological and phonemic awareness, phonics, fluency, and text comprehension was strongest, grounded in Scarborough's Rope and the Simple View of Reading and supported by high-quality instructional materials such as Heggerty and UFLI. Reading Diagnostics gave candidates practice administering assessments, analyzing data, and designing interventions. Reviewers found narrower coverage elsewhere. Candidates rarely assessed concepts of print or general oral language skills, and instruction in differentiating vocabulary and in higher-level cognitive writing processes was underdeveloped.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Have candidates administer print concepts assessments in field placements or Reading Diagnostics • Revise Reading Diagnostics to assess oral language formally and informally • Embed differentiation strategies for content, process, and product in fluency instruction • Explicitly address differentiating vocabulary instruction for students with diverse learning needs	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Six of the eight corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 2: QUALITY OF FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES

REVIEW AREA 2 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
APPROACHING 11 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Selection of clinical placement schools	Approaching
Selection of cooperating teachers (mentor teachers)	Below
Opportunities to observe models of effective early literacy practice	Exceeds
Field-based placements provide opportunities to use HQIM	Meets
Responsibilities build to candidate readiness for full responsibility	Exceeds
Opportunities to apply learning about multilingual children	Meets
Opportunities to apply learning about students who experience difficulty reading	Approaching
Mentor teachers are skillful and can coach candidates	Below
Faculty and supervisors guide and evaluate candidates through training	Approaching
Quality of written and oral feedback	Approaching
Student engagement and candidate impact on student learning	Approaching
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that field placements exposed candidates to diverse schools, including a site where combined English as a second language and special education enrollment reached 29 percent, and to high-quality instructional materials such as Foundations and CKLA. Candidates observed strong in-person and video models of science of reading instruction, and field assignments built in complexity across all four literacy courses. Reviewers found no formal, data-driven process for selecting placement schools or mentor teachers, and the program did not ensure that mentors could coach candidates in evidence-based literacy practice. Mentors received no formalized training. Feedback from supervisors and mentors was accurate but often general, lacking specificity and actionable steps.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Collect school and district performance data to guide candidate placements • Work with principals to identify mentors strong in the science of reading and in coaching • Train other field-based placement teachers to match current model quality • Collect and monitor data on HQIM use and implementation fidelity	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Four of the eight corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 3: QUALITY OF PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
APPROACHING 7 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Quality of data the program collects and uses	Approaching
Internal quality control gates (or checkpoints) and intervention plans	Approaching
Quality of monitoring	Approaching
Monitoring coursework quality, teaching quality, and clinical connections	Approaching
Quality improvement planning	Approaching
Partnerships improve candidate experiences with HQIM	Meets
Evaluation of partnerships for readiness to teach early literacy	Meets
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the program collected data from surveys, Praxis and foundations of reading scores, and candidate progress toward control gates, and that partnerships with area districts through the teacher education council shaped decisions about coursework and high-quality instructional materials. Reviewers found those processes largely informal. Data collection lacked standardization, feedback from field experiences was inconsistent, and the program had no formal strategic plan with measurable goals. Quality control gates were clearly defined, but no systematic intervention process existed for candidates who fell off track. Monitoring of coursework quality, clinical connections, and partnerships happened inconsistently and without a formal system.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Establish inter-rater reliability, formalize stakeholder feedback, and design a strategic plan • Implement proactive support and periodic check-ins for candidates at risk • Establish a formal system monitoring coursework, field experiences, and feedback data • Establish a process for monitoring coursework clinical connections with all stakeholders	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
No corrective action targets this review area.	

CORRECTIVE ACTION

Where a review identifies findings that require follow-up, the Division of Elementary and Secondary Education issues a corrective action determination. The Division selects from a standard set of corrective actions and marks each one required or recommended for the program. The recommendations under each review area above are the reviewers' advice; the actions below are what the Division has directed the program to do.

ACTIONS IDENTIFIED	REQUIRED	RECOMMENDED
8	3	5

The Division identified 8 corrective actions for this program, 3 required and 5 recommended. Required actions must be completed. Recommended actions are directed to the program as supports for the same findings. Some actions address more than one review area, so the per-area counts shown under each review area add to more than the total.

ACTIONS THE PROGRAM IS REQUIRED TO TAKE

CORRECTIVE ACTION	REVIEW AREA ADDRESSED	DESIGNATION	EVIDENCE REQUIRED
Walk-through tool training	RA2	REQUIRED	Walk-through tool training certificates
Cognitive coaching training	RA2	RECOMMENDED	Cognitive coaching training certificate
Inclusive practices training	RA1, RA2	RECOMMENDED	Inclusive practices training certificate
Defined partnerships and collaboration with dyslexia specialists at education cooperatives	RA1	RECOMMENDED	Certificate of completion from Southeast, Great Rivers, or Crowley's Ridge cooperative
Lesson plan internalization training (TNTP)	RA1	REQUIRED	Training certificate
Identify the HQIM in all partner districts and incorporate it into revised coursework	RA1	RECOMMENDED	Matrix of partner district HQIM and its inclusion in coursework
Small group instruction training, K-2 and 3-6	RA1, RA2	RECOMMENDED	Training certificate; participation through DESE and/or cooperatives
Literacy Foundations for English Learners book study (Elsa Cardenas-Hagan)	RA1	REQUIRED	Book study notes as documentation

OVERSIGHT

Each corrective action carries an evidence requirement, shown above. The program supplies the person responsible, the timeline for completion, and how each action will be used in the program when it submits its corrective action plan to the Division. Those execution details are not recorded in the determination and are therefore not published here.

Sources: TPI-US Written Report & Recommendations, Ouachita Baptist University, November 18-20, 2024, conducted under the TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024). Ouachita Baptist University Corrective Action Plan, Arkansas DESE. Rating scale language quoted from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework.